Notes version: 11 Nov 14:00 IST (if this time is old, reload the page)

HISTORY · Social and religious reform movements: 19th century

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? In the 1800s educated Indians began asking **why their society had weakened**. They blamed **evils** such as **sati, child marriage, a ban on widow remarriage, purdah, untouchability, caste rigidity and superstition**. Influenced by **Western rational ideas** and by **pride in India's own past**, they started **organisations (samajs)** to reform **religion** (one God, no idols, no priestly rituals) and **society** (women's education, widow remarriage, caste equality). Two methods: **reformist** (change through reason and new laws, e.g. Brahmo Samaj) and **revivalist** (go back to an idealised past, e.g. Arya Samaj). Learn it as **Why → Hindu reform bodies → caste and women's reformers → Muslim, Sikh and Parsi reform → Andhra → Impact**.

Major reform bodies

1. Raja Ram Mohan Roy and the Brahmo Samaj

Point	Details
Ram Mohan Roy	Wrote **Tuhfat-ul-Muwahhidin** (Persian, against idol worship, 1803–04); **Atmiya Sabha (1815)**; **'Precepts of Jesus' (1820)**; papers **Sambad Kaumudi (1821, Bengali)** and **Mirat-ul-Akhbar (1822, Persian)**; supported **English education** (Hindu College 1817; **Vedanta College 1825**); campaigned until **sati was banned (1829)**; given the title **'Raja'** by Mughal emperor **Akbar II**; died at **Bristol (1833)**.
Brahmo Samaj	**Brahmo Sabha** founded **20 August 1828** at Calcutta; worship of **one formless God**, against **idols, rituals, priests, caste and sati**; based on the **Upanishads** and reason.
Later leaders and splits	**Debendranath Tagore** (Tattvabodhini Sabha 1839) revived it; **Keshab Chandra Sen** spread it widely; **split 1866**: **Adi Brahmo Samaj** (Debendranath) and **Brahmo Samaj of India** (Keshab); the **Native Marriage Act (1872)** allowed Brahmo marriages; **split 1878**: Keshab married his **under-age daughter** to the **Maharaja of Cooch Behar**, against his own teaching, so his followers formed the **Sadharan Brahmo Samaj**.

2. Other Hindu reform bodies

Body	Founder, year, ideas
Young Bengal	**Henry Vivian Derozio**, teacher at **Hindu College**: radical free thinking, questioned all tradition (1820s–30s).

Prarthana Samaj	**Atmaram Pandurang**, **Bombay, 1867** (inspired by Keshab); leaders **M.G. Ranade** and **R.G. Bhandarkar**; **widow remarriage, women's education, inter-caste dining**; worked within Hinduism.
Arya Samaj	**Swami Dayananda Saraswati**, **Bombay, 1875**; book **Satyarth Prakash**; **'Go back to the Vedas'**; against **idols, caste by birth, child marriage**; **shuddhi** (reconversion); **DAV** schools (Lahore, 1886) and **Gurukul** (Haridwar, 1902) after his death.
Theosophical Society	**Madame Blavatsky** and **Col. H.S. Olcott**, **New York, 1875**; headquarters at **Adyar, Madras (1882)**; **Annie Besant** led it in India; praised **ancient Hindu and Buddhist** thought; **Central Hindu College, Benares (1898)**.
Ramakrishna Mission	**Swami Vivekananda**, **1897**, in the name of his guru **Ramakrishna Paramahamsa**; all religions are **paths to one truth**; **service to humanity is service to God**; famous speech at the **Chicago Parliament of Religions (1893)**.

3. Reformers for caste equality and women

Reformer	Work
Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar	Campaigned for the **Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act (1856)**; girls' schools (helped **Bethune School, 1849**); simplified Bengali learning (**Barna Parichay**).
Jyotiba Phule and **Savitribai Phule**	First **girls' school** in Pune (**1848**); **Satyashodhak Samaj (1873)** against **Brahmin dominance and caste**; book **Gulamgiri (1873)**.
Sri Narayana Guru	Kerala; **'One caste, one religion, one God for man'**; consecrated a Shiva idol at **Aruvippuram (1888)** as a challenge to caste rules; **SNDP Yogam (1903)**.
Pandita Ramabai, **Behramji Malabari**	Ramabai: **Arya Mahila Samaj (1882)**, **Sharada Sadan (1889)** for widows. Malabari: campaign that led to the **Age of Consent Act (1891)**.

4. Muslim, Sikh and Parsi reform

- **Aligarh Movement: Sir Syed Ahmad Khan**: **Scientific Society (1864)**, **Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College, Aligarh (1875)** (later Aligarh Muslim University, 1920), journal **Tahzib-ul-Akhlaq**; modern education and reason among Muslims. **Deoband (1866)**: Darul Uloom, orthodox and anti-British. **Ahmadiyya (1889)**: Mirza Ghulam Ahmad.
- **Sikh: Singh Sabha (Amritsar, 1873)**: education and reform, later the **Gurdwara reform (Akali) movement**. **Parsi: Rahnumai Mazdayasnan Sabha (1851)**: Dadabhai Naoroji and others; women's education.

5. The Andhra renaissance

Reformer	Work
Kandukuri Veeresalingam (1848–1919)	Born at **Rajahmundry**; journal **Viveka Vardhini (1874)**; **girls' school at Dowleswaram (1874)**; **Rajahmundry Social Reform Association (1878)**; performed the **first widow remarriage in Andhra on 11 December 1881** at Rajahmundry; wrote **Rajasekhara**

	Charitramu (often called the **first Telugu novel**); later **Hitakarini Samaj (1906)**; called the **'father of the Andhra renaissance'** and **'Gadya Tikkana'**.
Gurajada Apparao (1862–1915)	Play **Kanyasulkam (1892)** attacked **bride price** and **child marriage of girls to old men**; used **spoken Telugu**; Vizianagaram.
Raghupati Venkataratnam Naidu (1862–1939)	Leading **Brahmo** of Andhra; **anti-nautch** (against devadasi dance) and **social purity** campaigns; educationist.

6. Impact

Area	Points
Politics	Created a **self-confident educated class** and **pride in India's heritage**, the base of **nationalism**; reformers used **press and associations**, early forms of political work.
Society	Laws on **sati (1829)**, **widow remarriage (1856)**, **age of consent (1891)**; **women's education**; attack on **untouchability** and caste rules, though change was **slow** and mostly **urban and upper-caste** at first.
Economy	Schools and colleges produced **teachers, lawyers, doctors and clerks**; reformers such as **Ranade** linked reform with **economic progress**.
Religion	**Rational, monotheistic** religion; less **priestly control**; answer to **missionary criticism**; but **revivalist** groups also sharpened **religious identities**.

EXAM TRAP

Brahmo Sabha 20 Aug 1828 (Ram Mohan Roy); sati banned **1829**; Tattvabodhini **1839**; splits **1866**, **1878** (Sadharan); **Native Marriage Act 1872**; **Prarthana 1867** (Atmaram Pandurang, Ranade); **Arya 1875** (Dayananda, Satyarth Prakash); **Theosophical 1875**, Adyar 1882; **Ramakrishna Mission 1897**, Chicago **1893**; **Widow Remarriage Act 1856** (Vidyasagar); **Phule** 1848, **1873**; **Narayana Guru** 1888, SNDP 1903; **Aligarh** 1864, **1875**; **Deoband 1866**; **Singh Sabha 1873**; **Rahnumai 1851**; **Veeresalingam**: 1874, 1878, **11 Dec 1881**; **Kanyasulkam 1892**.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about the Brahmo Samaj:
1. Ram Mohan Roy founded the Brahmo Sabha in 1828.
2. Debendranath Tagore founded the Tattvabodhini Sabha.
3. After the split of 1866, Keshab Chandra Sen led the Brahmo Samaj of India.
4. The Sadharan Brahmo Samaj was formed in 1878 under Keshab Chandra Sen's leadership.
Which of the above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 2, 3 and 4 only

C. 1, 2, 3 and 4

D. 1, 2 and 3 only

Answer: D. The Sadharan Brahmo Samaj was formed by those who broke away from Keshab after the Cooch Behar marriage.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (organisation) with List-II (founder):
List-I: A. Arya Samaj B. Prarthana Samaj C. Satyashodhak Samaj D. Ramakrishna Mission
List-II: 1. Swami Vivekananda 2. Jyotiba Phule 3. Dayananda Saraswati 4. Atmaram Pandurang

A. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1

B. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

C. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1

D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: B. Arya: Dayananda; Prarthana: Atmaram Pandurang; Satyashodhak: Phule; Ramakrishna Mission: Vivekananda.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements is NOT correct?

A. The Young Bengal movement was led by Keshab Chandra Sen.

B. Satyarth Prakash was written by Dayananda Saraswati.

C. The Theosophical Society was founded in New York in 1875.

D. Sir Syed Ahmad Khan founded the Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College at Aligarh.

Answer: A. Young Bengal was led by Henry Vivian Derozio of Hindu College.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): Kandukuri Veeresalingam is called the father of the Andhra renaissance.
Reason (R): He started the journal Viveka Vardhini, opened girls' schools and performed the first

widow remarriage in Andhra in 1881.

Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: A. His pioneering work in journalism, women's education and widow remarriage explains the title.

PRACTICE

Arrange the founding of the following in chronological order:

1. Brahmo Sabha

2. Arya Samaj

3. Prarthana Samaj

4. Ramakrishna Mission

A. 1, 2, 3, 4

B. 3, 1, 2, 4

C. 1, 3, 2, 4

D. 1, 3, 4, 2

Answer: C. Brahmo Sabha 1828, Prarthana 1867, Arya 1875, Ramakrishna Mission 1897.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write Ram Mohan Roy's works and the Brahmo splits with years. 2. Write each samaj with founder, year, place and idea. 3. Write the caste and women's reformers, Muslim, Sikh, Parsi reform, and the Andhra reformers.

POLITY · National Human Rights Commission and other statutory bodies

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? A **statutory body** is created by an **Act of Parliament** (or a State law), not by the Constitution. So Parliament can **change or abolish it by amending the law**. These bodies **watch over the government**:

they protect **human rights** (NHRC), fight **corruption** (CVC, Lokpal, Lokayukta), and protect **women, minorities and children** (NCW, NCM, NCPCR). Most of them can **inquire and recommend**, but **cannot punish**; their power comes from **publicity, reports to Parliament and moral pressure**. Learn each as **Act → composition → who appoints → term → functions → limits**.

Statutory bodies at a glance

1. National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)

Point	Details
Law and origin	**Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993** (amended 2006 and **2019**); set up on **12 October 1993**; in line with the UN's **Paris Principles**. 'Human rights' means rights to **life, liberty, equality and dignity** guaranteed by the Constitution or international covenants and enforceable by Indian courts.
Composition	**Chairperson**: a former **Chief Justice of India or Supreme Court judge**; members: a former **SC judge**, a former **High Court Chief Justice or judge**, and **three** persons with knowledge of human rights (**at least one woman**). **Deemed members**: chairpersons of **NCSC, NCST, NCW, NCM, NCBC, NCPCR** and the Chief Commissioner for Persons with Disabilities.
Appointment and term	By the **President** on a committee's advice: **PM** (chair), **Lok Sabha Speaker**, **Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman**, **Leaders of the Opposition** in both Houses, **Union Home Minister**. Term **3 years or age 70**, eligible for reappointment. Removal by the **President** (misbehaviour or incapacity after a **Supreme Court inquiry**).
Functions and powers	**Inquire** into violations (on a petition or **suo motu**), with the **powers of a civil court**; **visit jails** and detention centres; **review laws** and treaties; spread **human rights literacy**; it may recommend **compensation** or **prosecution**, and approach the **Supreme Court or High Courts**.
Limits	Recommendations are **not binding**; it **cannot inquire** into a matter **more than one year after** it happened; limited role over the **armed forces** (it can only seek a report from the Centre).
State Human Rights Commission	Under the same Act; chair: former **High Court Chief Justice or judge**; appointed by the **Governor** on a committee led by the **Chief Minister**, but **removed only by the President**. Each district has a **Human Rights Court** (a Sessions Court).

2. Bodies against corruption

Body	Key facts

Central Vigilance Commission (CVC)	Set up in **1964** by a government resolution on the **Santhanam Committee**'s advice; made **statutory by the CVC Act, 2003**; **CVC + up to 2 Vigilance Commissioners**; **4 years or 65**; chosen by a committee of the **PM, Home Minister and Leader of the Opposition**; supervises vigilance and the **CBI's** corruption cases.
Lokpal	**Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013** (in force **2014**); idea from the **First ARC (1966)**; **chairperson + up to 8 members**, **half judicial**, and at least **half** from **SC, ST, OBC, minorities and women**; chosen by the **PM, Speaker, Leader of the Opposition, CJI (or a judge he names) and an eminent jurist**; covers the **PM** (with safeguards), ministers, MPs and officials; first Lokpal: **Justice Pinaki Chandra Ghose (2019)**.
Lokayukta	State-level anti-corruption body under **State laws**; **Maharashtra** set up the **first (1971)**; **Andhra Pradesh**: **AP Lokayukta and Upa-Lokayukta Act, 1983**.
CBI (note)	Set up by a **Home Ministry resolution (1963)**; gets its powers from the **Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946**; so it is **not a statutory body** in the strict sense.

3. Other statutory bodies

Body	Act and role
National Commission for Women (NCW)	**NCW Act, 1990**; set up **1992**; reviews laws and safeguards for women, inquires into complaints.
National Commission for Minorities (NCM)	**NCM Act, 1992**; six notified minorities: **Muslims, Christians, Sikhs, Buddhists, Parsis (Zoroastrians) and Jains** (Jains added in **2014**).
NCPCR	**Commissions for Protection of Child Rights Act, 2005**; set up **2007**; monitors the **RTE Act** and **POCSO Act**.
NGT, NDMA and others	**National Green Tribunal (2010 Act)** for environment cases; **National Disaster Management Authority (2005 Act)**, chaired by the **PM**; **Central Information Commission** under the **RTI Act, 2005** (Day 18).

EXAM TRAP

Constitutional (by an Article) vs **statutory** (by an Act) vs **executive** (by an order); **NHRC: PHRA 1993**, 12 Oct 1993, chair ex-CJI or SC judge, 3 + 2 judicial members, 7 deemed members, PM-led committee, **3 yrs/70**, **1-year limit**, not binding; **SHRC**: Governor appoints, President removes; **CVC 1964, Act 2003**, 4 yrs/65; **Lokpal Act 2013**, chair + 8, first 2019; **Lokayukta**: Maharashtra 1971, AP Act 1983; **CBI 1963, DSPE Act 1946**; **NCW 1990/1992**; **NCM 1992**, six minorities; **NCPCR 2005/2007**; **NGT 2010**; **NDMA 2005**.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about the National Human Rights Commission:

1. It is a statutory body set up under the Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993.

2. Its chairperson must be a former Chief Justice of India or a former judge of the Supreme Court.
3. Its recommendations are binding on the government.
4. It cannot inquire into a matter after one year from the date of the alleged violation.
Which of the above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 1, 2 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: B. NHRC recommendations are advisory, not binding.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (body) with List-II (origin):
List-I: A. Central Vigilance Commission B. Lokpal C. National Commission for Women D. NCPCR
List-II: 1. Act of 2005 2. Recommended by the Santhanam Committee 3. Act of 2013 4. Act of 1990

A. A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1

B. A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1

C. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1

D. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

Answer: C. CVC: Santhanam Committee; Lokpal: 2013 Act; NCW: 1990 Act; NCPCR: 2005 Act.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements is NOT correct?

A. The National Commission for Women is a statutory body.

B. The Central Bureau of Investigation was created by an Act of Parliament.

C. Half of the members of the Lokpal must be judicial members.

D. The chairperson of the NCW is a deemed member of the NHRC.

Answer: B. The CBI was set up by a Home Ministry resolution in 1963 and draws its powers from the DSPE Act, 1946.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): The Lokpal can inquire into allegations of corruption against the Prime Minister, subject to certain safeguards.
Reason (R): The Lokpal is a constitutional body created under Article 323C.
Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: C. A is true. R is false: the Lokpal is a statutory body under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013.

PRACTICE

A citizen of Andhra Pradesh wants to file a complaint of corruption against a State minister. Which body is the most appropriate?

A. National Human Rights Commission

B. Lokpal

C. AP Lokayukta

D. Central Vigilance Commission

Answer: C. Corruption by State public servants, including ministers, falls under the State Lokayukta.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write constitutional vs statutory vs executive bodies with two examples each. 2. Write the NHRC fully: Act, composition, committee, term, powers, limits; and the SHRC. 3. Write CVC, Lokpal, Lokayukta, NCW, NCM, NCPCR, NGT and NDMA with their Acts.

MATHS · Data analysis: line graphs and pie charts

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? A **line graph** joins points over **time**, so it shows **trends**: where it **rises**, **falls**, how **steeply** (a steeper line means a bigger change), and when **two lines cross**. A **pie chart** shows how a **whole (100% = 360°)** is **divided into parts**. In a pie chart, **one percent is 3.6°**, so the **central angle = percentage × 3.6**

and the **amount = percentage × total ÷ 100**. You use the same four tools as Day 16 (% change, share, average, ratio).

1. Line graph: worked example



Line graph used in questions 1–3

- **Gap between lines = surplus or deficit:** exports − imports = 10, 10, **−5**, 5, 10, **15**. So imports were **more** than exports **only in 2021**, and the surplus was **largest in 2024**.
- **Steepest segment = biggest change:** exports 2021 → 2022 rose by **15** (55 → 70, about **27.3%**), the biggest rise; imports rose **every year**, but exports **fell** once (2020 → 2021).
- **% change still divides by the earlier year:** exports 2022 → 2023: 10 ÷ 70 ≈ **14.3%**.

2. Pie chart: worked example



Pie chart used in questions 4 and 5

Item	Share	Angle (× 3.6)	Amount (of ₹40,000)
Food	30%	108°	₹12,000
Rent	25%	90°	₹10,000
Education	15%	54°	₹6,000
Savings	12%	43.2°	₹4,800
Transport	10%	36°	₹4,000
Others	8%	28.8°	₹3,200

- **Ratio shortcut:** the ratio of two items = the ratio of their **percentages** (Rent : Education = 25 : 15 = **5 : 3**); you need the total only to find **amounts**.
- **Common traps:** a pie chart shows **shares, not growth**; when **two pie charts** have **different totals**, a bigger share does **not** always mean a bigger amount.

EXAM TRAP

Line graph: steeper = bigger change; gap between lines = difference; crossing point = they become equal. **Pie chart:** 100% = 360°, **1% = 3.6°**, angle = % × 3.6, amount = % × total ÷ 100, ratio = ratio of %; compare amounts only with the **same total**.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

(Line graph) In which year were the company's imports more than its exports?

A. 2020

B. 2021

C. 2022

D. 2023

Answer: B. Only in 2021: imports 60, exports 55.

PRACTICE

(Line graph) By about what percentage did exports rise from 2022 to 2023?

A. 10%

B. 12.5%

C. 14.3%

D. 16.7%

Answer: C. (80 − 70)/70 × 100 ≈ 14.3%.

PRACTICE

(Line graph) Consider the following statements:

1. The excess of exports over imports was the highest in 2024.

2. Imports increased every year from 2019 to 2024.

3. Exports increased every year from 2019 to 2024.

Which of the above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 2 and 3 only

C. 1 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A. The 2024 surplus is 15 (the highest); imports rose every year; exports fell from 60 to 55 in 2021.

PRACTICE

(Pie chart) What is the central angle of the sector for Education?

A. 45°

B. 60°

C. 72°

D. 54°

Answer: D. 15 × 3.6 = 54°.

PRACTICE

(Pie chart) How much does the family save each month?

A. ₹5,200

B. ₹6,000

C. ₹4,800

D. ₹4,000

Answer: C. 12% of ₹40,000 = ₹4,800.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write how to read a line graph: slope, gap, crossing. 2. Write the pie chart rules: 1% = 3.6°, angle, amount, ratio. 3. Redo questions 3 and 5 without looking.

NOTEBOOK PAGE · Day 17: write this from memory

Close the notes. Write these headings, fill every blank, then correct in a different colour.

HISTORY: 19th-century reform movements

Area	Write
Hindu reform	Brahmo (1828; splits 1866, 1878), Prarthana (1867), Arya (1875), Ramakrishna Mission (1897), Theosophical (1875), Young Bengal: founder, year, place, main idea
Caste and women	Phule (1848 school, Satyashodhak 1873), Narayana Guru, Vidyasagar (1856 Act), Pandita Ramabai, Malabari (1891)

Muslim, Sikh, Parsi	Aligarh (1864, 1875), Deoband (1866), Ahmadiyya (1889), Singh Sabha (1873), Rahnumai Mazdayasnan Sabha (1851)
Andhra	Veeresalingam (1874, 1878, 1881), Gurajada (1892), Raghupati Venkataratnam Naidu

POLITY: NHRC and statutory bodies

- NHRC: Act, composition, appointing committee, term, functions, limits; SHRC; then CVC, Lokpal, Lokayukta, NCW, NCM, NCPCR, NGT, NDMA with Act year; CBI is not statutory.

MATHS: Line graphs and pie charts

Write: read the slope (steepest rise or fall); gap between two lines; central angle = % × 3.6; amount = % × total; ratio of two sectors = ratio of their percentages; redo one question from each chart.